What does the visual-quality criterion actually measure?

Sixteen operations plus the deployed score, a 19-extractor ablation, and end-to-end segment substitution

Redundancy cluster

Band 0:00–0:12

Record 4:24–7:32

CNN 1:12–1:37

candidates the pipeline treats as redundant, and exactly one enters the summary

Scoring operation

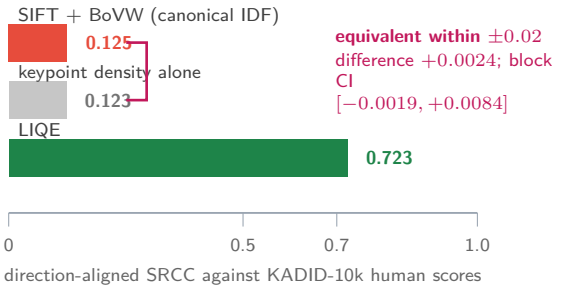
In use: SIFT → BoVW → TF-IDF sum

designed for retrieval and categorization, not for quality

Eligible: LIQE, QualiCLIP, CLIP-IQA+

three complete-case methods clear the operational screen

Controlled-distortion database



Take-away

The score factors as $\text{score} = D \cdot \overline{\text{idf}}$: a descriptor **count** times a **mean IDF weight**. Which channel governs depends on the extractor and distribution; neither predicts quality reliably in the **evaluated configurations**.

Replacing the descriptor with 19 CNN extractors does not repair the **aggregation**.

Three still-image methods clear the operational screen, stable over generalization cuts from 0.60 to 0.65.

Four-phase protocol

1 Sensitivity to controlled degradation → **2** Agreement on redundancy clusters → **3** Human scores on 3 databases, P.1401 → **4** Ablation over 19 CNN extractors

four evidence streams, one protocol, one decision per redundancy cluster